

Tuesday, 29 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 26° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Heavy drizzle 24° 12°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 18° 9°
------------------------------------	--	-----------------------------------	-------------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The UK government is in talks with the US to prevent a potential ban on diesel exports, threatened by Donald Trump.

Former President Trump has indicated he might halt US diesel exports if re-elected. This move could have significant implications for global energy markets and the UK's fuel supplies.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Counter-terror police are leading an investigation after five men were arrested near the vital US airbase, RAF Fairford.

The arrests were made under the Explosives Act and on suspicion of preparing a terrorist act. The incident has raised concerns about security at the base, which is a key US launchpad.

TERRORISM · UK
- 3

The parole hearing for James Bulger's killer will be held in private, despite demands from his mother, Denise Fergus, for a public hearing.

This decision means the proceedings will not be open to the public or media. The case continues to be a highly sensitive and emotive issue for many in the UK.

CRIME · UK
- 4

A scheme to resettle refugees in the UK is set to reopen, with a focus on Afghan women and girls, and Palestinians.

The UK Resettlement Scheme aims to provide a safe haven for vulnerable individuals. Approximately a quarter of those arriving are expected to be from these specific groups.

IMMIGRATION · UK
- 5

The Chancellor has stated that offering young people jobs, not benefits, is the best thing the government can provide.

John Healey's comments come ahead of next month's Budget, as he faces pressure to manage government borrowing costs. It highlights the focus on employment as a key policy priority.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Get ready for more backstabbing and deception as *Celebrity Traitors* returns to screens this Thursday!**

Twenty-one stars will be vying to win £100,000 for their chosen charities in the highly anticipated second series. Expect plenty of drama and guessing games as the 'big dogs' and 'dark horses' are revealed.

ON AIR – Who do you think will be the ultimate Traitor or Faithful this season?

TV · THIS WEEK
- 2 The classic TV show *'Our Friends in the North'* is being adapted for the stage, with its writer confident it will resonate with modern audiences.**

Peter Flannery believes the themes and stories from the original series remain highly relevant today. It's a chance for a new generation to experience this acclaimed drama.

ON AIR – Which classic TV shows would you love to see get a stage adaptation?

THEATRE · COMING SOON
- 3 Catherine Zeta-Jones is basing her latest role on the 'funny Welsh people' she knows, in her new film *'Kill Jackie'*.**

She plays Jackie Price, a former cocaine dealer targeted by assassins, promising a thrilling and perhaps humour-infused performance. It's always great to see her on screen!

ON AIR – Who are some of your favourite Welsh actors or personalities?

FILM · COMING SOON
- 4 U2 have celebrated their 50th anniversary by going back to their roots, playing a gig at the Dublin school where they first formed.**

It's a fantastic milestone for the iconic rock band, marking half a century since they met in a playground. What a way to celebrate their incredible journey!

ON AIR – What's your favourite U2 song, and what memories does it bring back?

MUSIC · ANNIVERSARY
- 5 An Indian film from Nagaland, *'Angh'*, is now on a path to the Oscars after a major win at the Toronto Film Festival.**

The film brings a rarely seen world to global cinema, offering a unique cultural perspective. It's exciting to see international cinema gaining such recognition.

ON AIR – Are there any lesser-known films or international movies you'd recommend?

FILM · AWARDS

On the schedule

- 1 Manchester City's CEO remains defiant following reports the club has been found guilty of numerous Premier League charges.**

Ferran Soriano has reportedly issued a strong message to other club executives. This comes after sources suggest City broke the majority of the 115 financial rules they were accused of.

ON AIR – If the reports are true, what do you think the appropriate sanctions for Manchester City should be?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Tom Banton has scored a 'brilliant' maiden ODI century for England in the deciding game against Sri Lanka at The Oval.**

His fantastic performance helped England secure a crucial win in the third match of the series. It's a significant milestone for the young batsman.

ON AIR – Which young English cricketers are you most excited about right now?

CRICKET · UK
- 3 England's Nations League squad faces doubts as Ezri Konsa and Nico O'Reilly are both uncertain for Tuesday night's match against the Czech Republic.**

Manager Thomas Tuchel is expected to make a final decision on their fitness on Tuesday morning. Their potential absence could impact England's lineup.

ON AIR – Who would you like to see step up for England if Konsa and O'Reilly are out?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Chelsea secured a feisty derby win over Arsenal at Stamford Bridge, continuing their steady start to the Women's Super League season.**

A goal from Thompson was enough to give Chelsea the victory in a highly competitive match. It was a crucial three points in the WSL title race.

ON AIR – Who do you think will win the Women's Super League this season?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 The United States has retained the Presidents Cup, completing a thrilling final day comeback to beat the Internationals.**

This marks their 11th successive title win in the prestigious golf tournament. It was a dramatic finish to a hard-fought competition.

ON AIR – What's your favourite golf tournament to watch, and why?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 Brightening up your local area could be as simple as painting a mural.**
A recent article highlights how community art projects, like vibrant murals, are not just visually appealing but also foster local pride and reduce feelings of isolation.
- 2 The surprising joy of 'micro-adventures' is gaining traction across the UK.**
These are short, local excursions – think an overnight camp in the garden or a hike in a nearby park – offering a refreshing break without extensive planning or cost.
- 3 More people are finding relaxation in the quiet art of 'birdwatching from their window'.**
A new piece suggests that observing garden birds can be a wonderfully mindful activity, connecting us with nature even from the comfort of our homes.
- 4 The simple act of 'sharing home-baked goods with neighbours' is making a comeback.**
This lovely tradition is being rediscovered as a delightful way to build community spirit and spread a little bit of homemade cheer.
- 5 A study reveals the unexpected positive impact of 'listening to classical music while doing chores'.**
It seems the harmonious tunes can make mundane tasks feel more enjoyable and even boost productivity around the house.
- 6 The charming trend of 'decorating outdoor spaces with fairy lights' is illuminating neighbourhoods.**
People are finding that a touch of twinkling light can transform a garden or balcony into a magical evening retreat, creating a lovely ambiance.
- 7 Researchers are noting the benefits of 'taking a leisurely stroll through a historic town centre'.**
Exploring ancient streets and unique architecture is proving to be a lovely way to combine gentle exercise with a fascinating cultural experience.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a special blend. What is it?

ANSWER: WARMING THE MUG FIRST, EVEN IF THE COFFEE ITSELF IS PIPING HOT!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of bread will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GOOD SQUEEZE TO CHECK ITS 'SQUISHINESS' FACTOR!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of shop' just instantly makes you feel nostalgic, perhaps because of its old-fashioned charm or the specific items it sells?

What kind of shop is it for you, and what memories does it bring back?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of self-care' that, no matter how busy things get, you always try to make time for because it genuinely makes you feel better, don't we?

What's that little treat or ritual you make sure to indulge in?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights can make audible crackling sounds that can be heard by people on the ground.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public park was Birkenhead Park in Merseyside, which opened in 1847.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically one-hundredth of a second.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The inventor of the Pringle's can is buried in one, as per his last wish.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, which have chemoreceptors to detect suitable host plants.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The tiny pocket on jeans was originally designed for a pocket watch.
- A group of flamingos is called a flamboyance.

On this day

Day 272 of the year, 93 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles, Duke of Brittany; Christian feast day: Cyriacus the Anchorite; Christian feast day: Hripsime; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisc de Paula Castelló Aleu. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Chris Broad, English cricketer and referee
- 1976 — Darren Byfield, English-Jamaican footballer
- 1994 — Halsey, American singer
- 1973 — Alfie Boe, English tenor and actor
- 1962 — Roger Bart, American actor
- 1966 — Ben Miles, English actor
- 1970 — Emily Lloyd, English actress
- 1966 — Jill Whelan, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1975 — WGPR becomes the first black-owned-and-operated television station in the US.
- 1954 — The convention establishing CERN (the European Organization for Nuclear Research) is signed.
- 2004 — The asteroid 4179 Toutatis passes within four lunar distances of Earth.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2019 — Violence and low turnout mar the 2019 Afghan presidential election.
- 1971 — Oman joins the Arab League.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2006 — A Boeing 737 and an Embraer 600 collide in mid-air, killing 154 people and triggering a Brazilian aviation crisis.
- 1959 — A Lockheed L-188 Electra crashes in Buffalo, Texas, killing 34 people.
- 1975 — WGPR becomes the first black-owned-and-operated television station in the US.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 273 of the year, 92 days left in 2026. Today Agricultural Reform (Nationalization) Day (São Tomé and Príncipe); Birth of Morelos (Mexico); Blasphemy Day, educates individuals and groups about blasphemy laws and defends freedom of expression; Boy's Day (Poland). Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1992 — Ezra Miller, American actor and singer
- 1962 — Marley Marl, American record producer and rapper
- 1958 — Marty Stuart, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1944 — Jimmy Johnstone, Scottish footballer (died 2006)
- 1966 — Gary Armstrong, Scottish rugby player
- 1967 — Gibby Haynes, American musician, radio personality and painter
- 1940 — Dewey Martin, Canadian-American drummer (died 2009)
- 1957 — Fran Drescher, American actress, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1939 — World War II: General Władysław Sikorski becomes prime minister of the Polish government-in-exile.
- 2016 — Two paintings with a combined value of \$100 million are recovered after having been stolen from the Van Gogh Museum in 2002.
- 1975 — Malév Flight 240 crashes into the Mediterranean Sea while on approach to Beirut International Airport in Beirut, Lebanon, killing 60.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1968 — The Boeing 747 is rolled out and shown to the public for the first time.
- 1966 — Bechuanaland declares its independence, and becomes the Republic of Botswana.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar